



DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY
NAVAL HISTORICAL CENTER
Washington Navy Yard
Washington, D. C. 20374

IN REPLY REFER TO

Ser 973/AR
31 August 1983

CWO4 [REDACTED], USNR
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

Dear Mr. [REDACTED]

In response to your recent request, I am enclosing a copy of ROOSEVELT's command history for 1956. As you will note, no report was entered regarding sightings of unidentified flying objects. Nor do we have other sources in our collections that would confirm these alleged observations. The information you have compiled on this subject (enclosure (1) to your letter of 10 August) is not security classified and we are aware of no regulation that would bar its release to civilians.

Since ship's logs are maintained by the Navy's Deck Log Section, Room BD 757, Pentagon, we have referred your request to that office for further reply.

Sincerely yours,

[REDACTED]

Archives Branch

[REDACTED] Ambassador of Honduras; Commander Caribbean Sea Frontier; Commandant 15th Naval District. The ship was also opened for general visiting. The scheduled stop at Callao, Peru from July 2 to July 6 was cancelled and on 30 June the ship dep[REDACTED] Chile.

On 2 July the USS ROOSEVELT entered the domain of NEPTUNUS REX, who came aboard with full honors and carried out the difficult job of transforming approximately 2600 slippery, slimy Pollywogs into the Ancient Order of the Deep as Shellbacks. At 1530 that day the ship crossed the Equator, Longitude 81-12-00 West.

On 9 July the USS ROOSEVELT entered Valparaiso Harbor, Chile, firing a twenty-one gun salute to the Chilean Nation, and then a thirteen gun salute to RADM MANUEL QUINTANA OYARZUN, C.N., Commandante en Jefe de la Escuadra de Operaciones, and later, a fifteen gun salute to the Honorable Governor of the Province of Valparaiso, ERNEST VIO VALDIVIESO, a thirteen gun salute to RADM SORGE EXCEBEDO DIAZ, C.N., a nineteen gun salute to ADM don FRANCISCO O'RYAN ORREGO, C.N., the Chilean minister of Defense, and a nineteen gun salute to the Honorable CECIL B. LYON, U.S. Ambassador to Chile. After an enjoyable stay the ship left on 13 July for Rio de Janeiro Via Cape Horn.

After passing through rough seas, the USS ROOSEVELT rounded Cape Horn on 17 July and proceeded to the southernmost point of her trip, Latitude 61-58-00 South, thence east of the Falklands Islands enroute to Rio.

On 24 July the USS ROOSEVELT entered Rio de Janeiro, firing a twenty-one gun salute to the Nation of Brazil. Among the visitors to the Commanding Officer were the Honorable ELLIS O. BRIGGS, U.S. Ambassador to Brazil; VADM CARNEIRO, CINCPRAZFLT; and VADM PAULO MARIO, Commander 1st Naval District.

The ship left for Mayport, Florida, on 28 July.

On 8 August, the USS ROOSEVELT steamed into the Mayport Carrier Basin, receiving a large "Welcome Home" from the families of the Officers and men.

~~The Commanding Officer, Captain J. T. HAYWARD was admitted to the Naval Hospital, Jacksonville, Florida and the Executive Officer, Commander J.B.~~

HOWLAND temporarily assumed command. During the ship's stay at Mayport, she operated with AIR GROUP 17 and various squadrons qualifying pilots in carrier landings using the mirror system. During this period operations were hindered by one hurricane which was circumnavigated. On 27 August the ship got underway for Guantanamo Bay, Cuba, where shakedown training was conducted, and qualifying of pilots in carrier landings was continued.

While in the Guantanamo area the ship spent one weekend in Port au Prince, Haiti, for rest and recreation. On 29 September, [REDACTED], USN, reported aboard for duty, and on 1 October, he assumed command of the USS ROOSEVELT. Having completed the exercises with the Fleet Training Group, the ship left Guantanamo on 18 October, arriving in Mayport on 20 October for a short stay before proceeding to Norfolk, Virginia, on 25 October arriving on 27 October. The ship moored at the Naval Base piers. On 30 October the ship was placed on seventy-two hour notice for deployment, all liberty and leave being cancelled.

At 0600 hours on 7 November 1956 the ROOSEVELT, with AIR GROUP 17, steamed out of Hampton Roads as part of Task Force TWENTY SIX, under the command of Rear Admiral ARNOLD. Proceeding under Commander Task Force TWENTY SIX, all movements were secret, until 24 November. Respite from three weeks at sea was enjoyed by a four day visit to Lisbon, Portugal, from 26 to 30 November 1956.